

BABBLERS, LAUGHING THRUSHES, AND RELATIVES

Generally more gregarious, noisier, and less migratory than warblers, the babblers and laughing thrushes of the families Timaliidae and Leiothrichidae have evolved into a variety of warbler-like and thrush-like forms. Some species are brightly coloured.



WHITE-EARED SIBIA

Heterophasia auricularis

Sibias are nectar-feeding babblers. This species is confined to Taiwan, where its distinctive call is often heard in mountain forests.

14 cm
5½ in



RED-TAILED MINLA

Minla ignotincta

This small babbler is similar to a tit. It is a noisy inhabitant of montane forest canopies in Nepal, China, and Myanmar.

33 cm
13 in



GREATER NECKLACED LAUGHING-THRUSH

Garrulax pectoralis

Laughing thrushes are large forest babblers with laughing calls. They often move in mixed flocks. This species inhabits the Himalayas and S.E. Asia.

18 cm
7 in



SILVER-EARED MESIA

Leiothrix argentea

A skulking, montane forest bird, this S.E. Asian species belongs to a group of "song babblers", which includes minlas, sibias, and laughing thrushes.

CHESTNUT-CAPPED BABBLER

Timalia pileata

A bird of low thickets in S.E. Asia, this babbler is often found near water, along with flycatchers and other babblers.

dark red wing patch

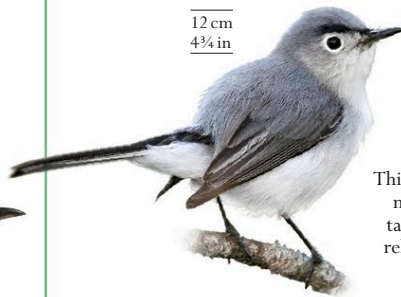
16–17 cm
6½ in

silver-grey ear patch

GNATCATCHERS

These small American insect-eaters from the family Polioptilidae are related to wrens, but are more warbler-like in appearance. In common with several members of the wren family, some gnatcatchers cock their tail when foraging.

12 cm
4¾ in



BLUE-GREY GNATCATCHER

Polioptila caerulea

This N. American gnatcatcher may flick its white-edged tail to flush insects. Unlike related gnatcatcher species, males do not have dark head markings.

TREECREEPERS

From the family Certhiidae, these are small insect-eating birds of the northern hemisphere. They forage on vertical tree trunks using their tail as a prop, habitually climbing one tree and flying to the bottom of the next.

EURASIAN TREECREEPER

Certhia familiaris

This is the most widespread *Certhia* tree creeper. It is found across Eurasia, from Britain to Japan, in broadleaf and coniferous forests.

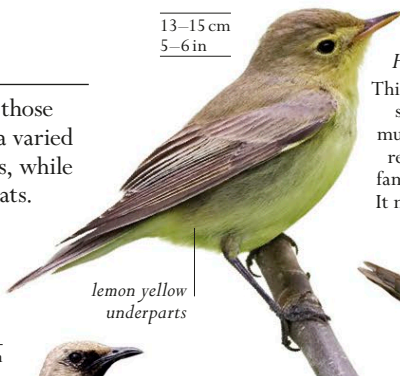
13 cm
5 in



OLD WORLD WARBLERS AND RELATIVES

Several families, such as the large and widespread Sylviidae and those with fewer species such as Madagascar's Bernieridae, comprise a varied group of thin-billed, insectivorous birds. Some are forest species, while others inhabit low bushes, dense grasses, or taller reedbed habitats. Many are subtly patterned and difficult to tell apart.

13–15 cm
5–6 in



ICTERINE WARBLER

Hippolais icterina

This Eurasian woodland species has a more musical call than other reed warblers of the family Acrocephalidae. It migrates to southern Africa in winter.

lemon yellow underparts

13 cm
5 in

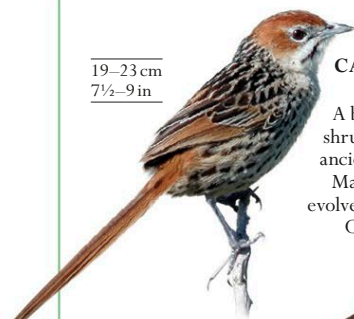


SEDGE WARBLER

Acrocephalus schoenobaenus

This is one of many species of reed warblers (inhabitants of wetland areas) that breeds in Eurasia and winters in Africa.

19–23 cm
7½–9 in



CAPE GRASSBIRD

Sphenoeacus afer

A bird of South African shrubland, it belongs to an ancient African family, the Macrosphenidae, which evolved separately from other Old World warblers.

18–24 cm
7–9½ in

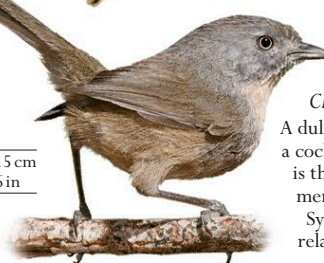


BROWN SONGLARK

Cincloramphus cruralis

This "grassbird" warbler from Australia in the family Locustellidae is a nomad of open habitats. Like larks, it sallies skywards from exposed perches.

15 cm
6 in



WRENTIT

Chamaea fasciata
A dull-coloured bird with a cocked tail, the wrentit is the only New World member of the family Sylviidae. It may be related to parrotbills.

12 cm
4¾ in



VINOUS-THROATED PARROTBILL

Sinosuthora webbiana

Despite its stumpy seed-cracking bill, this long-tailed Asian parrotbill is a member of the insectivorous Old World warblers family Sylviidae. This species occurs in China and Korea.

BLACKCAP

Sylvia atricapilla

Male *Sylvia* warblers are typically patterned with patches of black or brown. In this widespread Eurasian species, females have a brown cap.

14 cm
5½ in



12–13 cm
4¾–5 in



SUBALPINE WARBLER

Sylvia cantillans

Like many *Sylvia* warblers, this species breeds in scrubby Mediterranean habitats and winters in Africa.